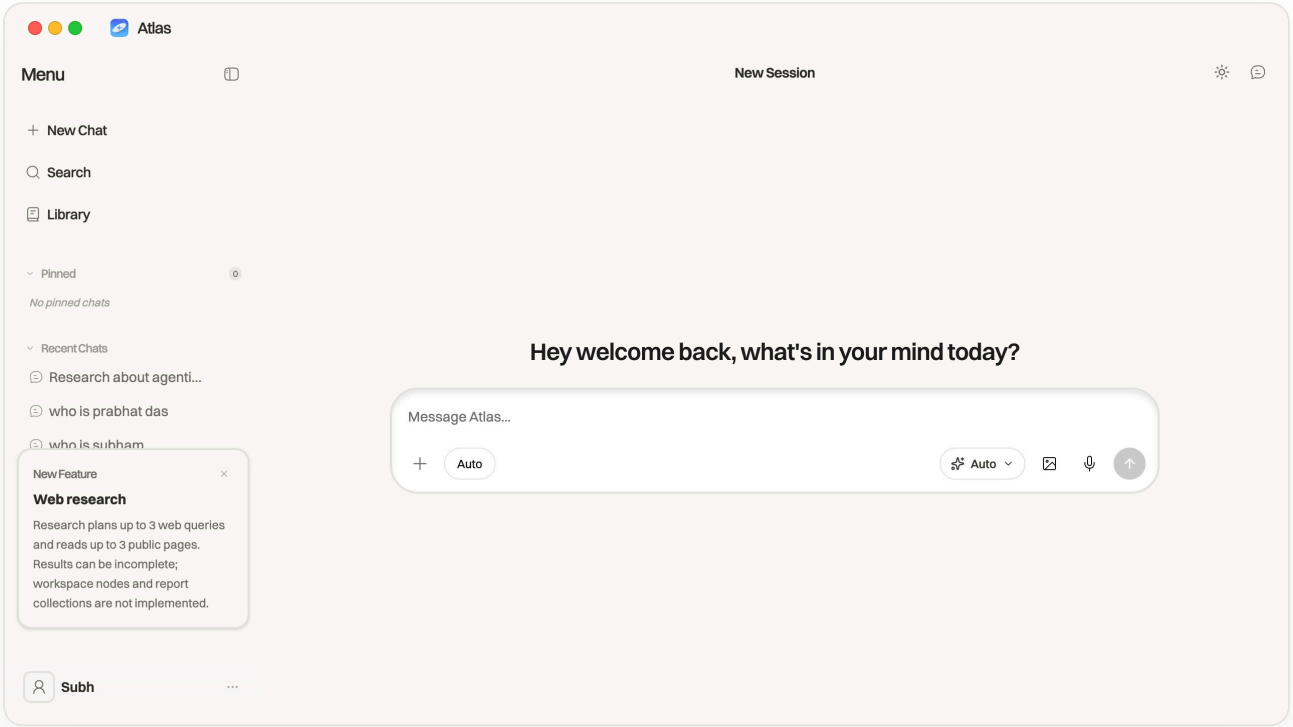
Atlas

Atlas User Manual

A complete guide to using Atlas after onboarding: chatting with cloud and local AI models, web search and research, drafting documents, managing your chats, and setting up API keys and local model servers.



For Atlas 1.0.8 · macOS desktop app

October 2026

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About the screenshots

All screenshots in this manual were taken from the real Atlas 1.0.8 desktop app on macOS. Your sidebar will show your own chats, and the providers marked "Connected" will depend on which keys you have added.

1 What Atlas is

Atlas is a local-first desktop AI assistant. One app lets you chat with the AI provider of your choice, or with a model running on your own computer, and adds web search, multi-step research, document drafting and long-term memory on top.

"Local-first" means the app and its engine run on your Mac: your chats, settings, API keys and memory are stored on your computer, not in an Atlas cloud account. When you pick a **cloud** model (OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, OpenRouter), your message is sent to that provider using **your own API key**. When you pick a **local** model (Ollama, LM Studio, vLLM), your message never leaves your computer for the chat itself.

What you can do with Atlas

FEATURE	WHAT IT GIVES YOU	NEEDS
Multi-provider chat	Chat with OpenAI, Anthropic (Claude), Google Gemini, OpenRouter, or any OpenAI-compatible local server. Switch models at any time, even mid-conversation.	At least one API key or a local model server
Auto model routing	Atlas classifies each message (research, coding, documentation) and picks a suitable model for you, local first, with an optional cloud fallback.	Any connected model
Live streaming replies	Answers appear word by word, with Markdown formatting and code highlighting.	—
Web search	A quick, single-query search with up to 5 cited sources shown under the answer.	Free web search (no key) or a Tavily key
Research	A deeper run: plans up to 3 searches, reads up to 3 public pages and writes a cited answer.	Web search set up
Plan	Produces a visible step-by-step outline before answering.	Any model
Draft document	Writes a research brief, comparison, decision memo or README that you review and then save as a Markdown file.	Any model
Safe tools	Lets supported cloud models call a small set of read-only tools (no shell, no code execution, no arbitrary file access).	A tool-capable OpenAI, Anthropic or Gemini model
Image generation	Create images from a text description.	OpenAI or Gemini key
Attachments	Attach text and code files (and images) so the model can read them.	—
Voice typing	Dictate your message with the microphone button.	Groq key
Persistent memory	Atlas can recall relevant past conversations and keeps a rolling summary of long chats.	—

Chat library	Search, pin, rename, delete and export (PDF) your conversations.	—
Selected documents	Index your own .txt / .md files and search their text locally.	—
App lock & themes	Password-protect the app; choose Light, Dark or System theme.	—

The fastest way to get going

1) Open **Profile → Advanced** and add one API key (Gemini's is free to create) or point Atlas at a local model.
2) Go back to chat, leave the model on **Auto**, and type your question. Everything else in this manual is optional.

2 Signing in and the main window

Signing in

If you set a password during onboarding, Atlas asks for it each time it opens. Enter the email and password you created and click **Log In**. The account is local to this Mac: it protects your stored chats and keys and is not an online account. You can change or remove the password later in **Profile → App lock** (see Chapter 11).

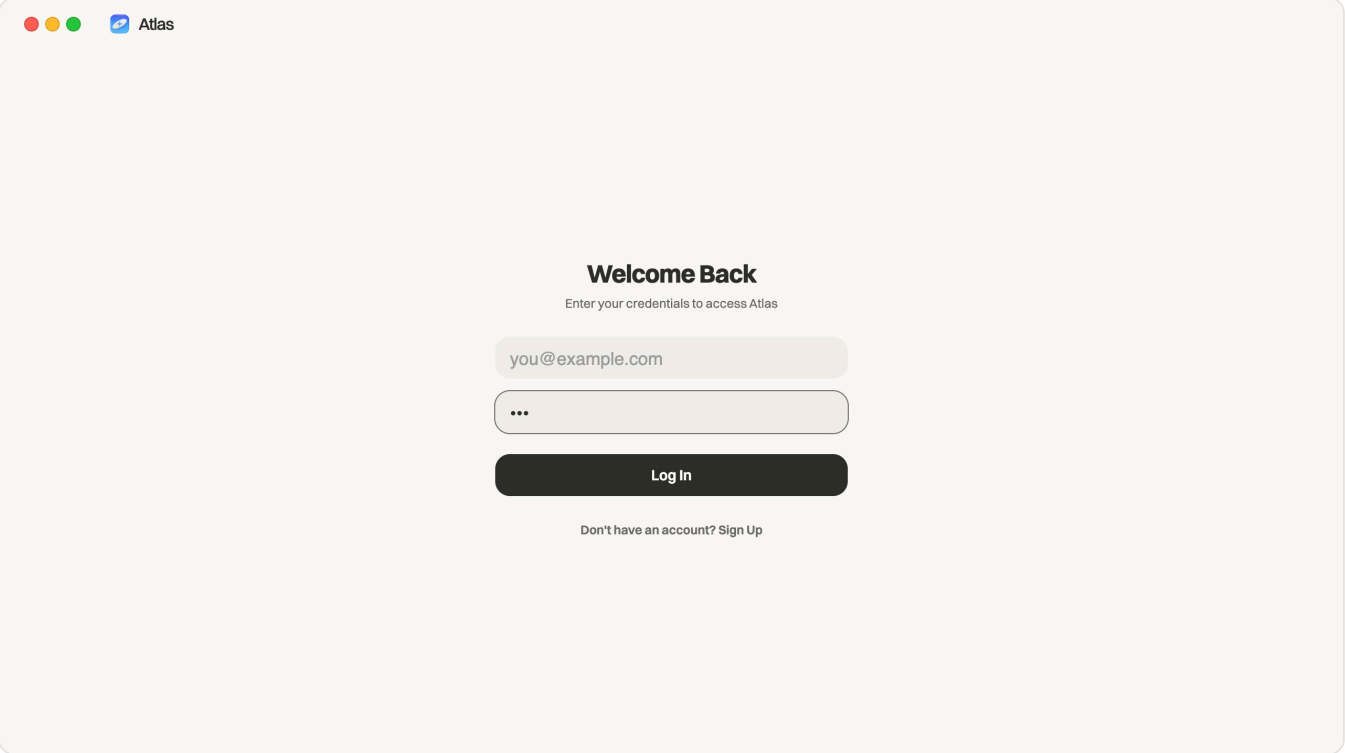


Figure 2.1 — The Atlas sign-in screen. Your email is pre-filled; type your password and press Log In.

A tour of the main window

After signing in you land on the home screen. It has two areas: the **sidebar** on the left and the **chat area** on the right.

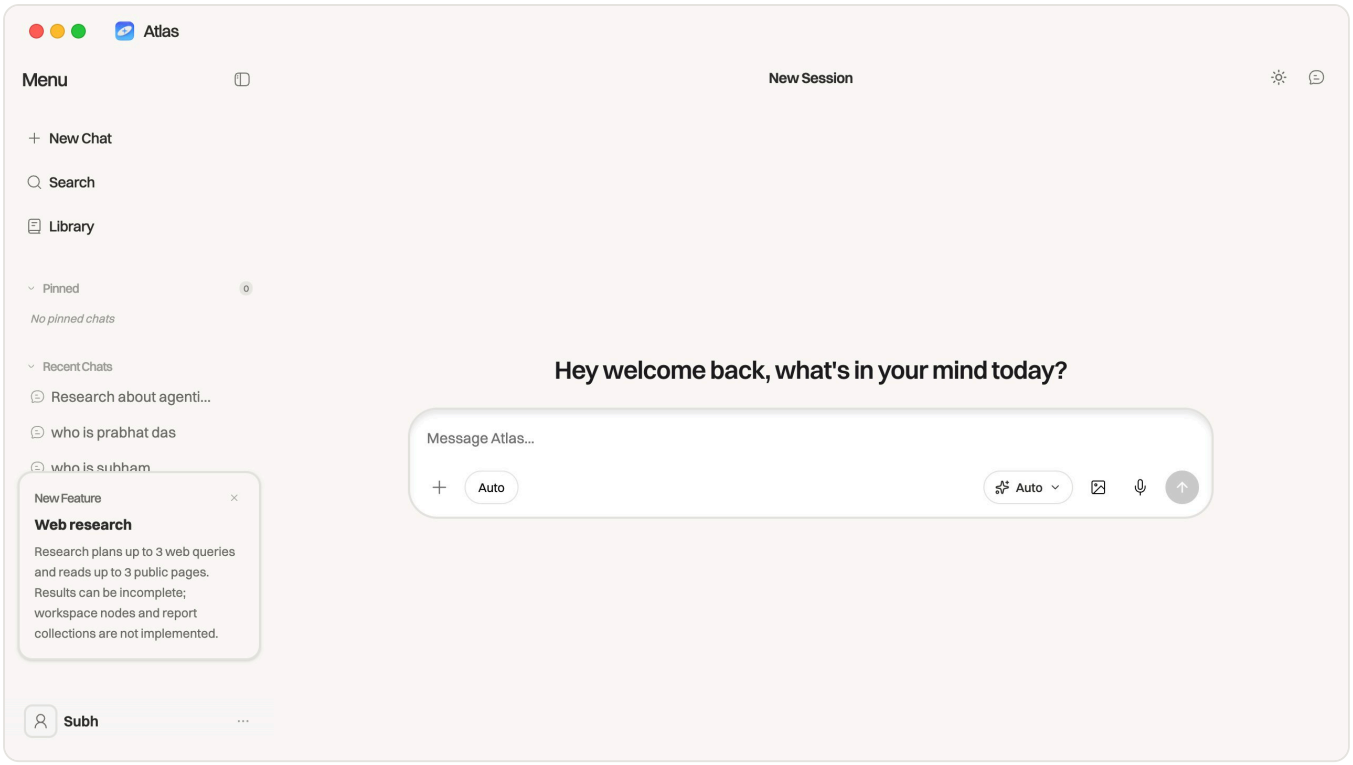


Figure 2.2 — The home screen. Sidebar on the left; greeting and message composer in the centre.

AREA / CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Menu (sidebar toggle)	The panel icon next to "Menu" collapses the sidebar for a distraction-free view. Click the same icon in the chat header to bring it back.
New Chat	Starts a fresh conversation.
Search	Turns into a search box that filters your chats by title.
Library	Opens the full chat library and your indexed documents (Chapter 10).
Pinned	Chats you have pinned stay here at the top. The badge shows how many.
Recent Chats	Your conversations, newest first. A small green dot means a reply is still being written.
New Feature card	Announces new features (currently Web research). Click × to dismiss it.
Your name (bottom)	The ··· button opens a menu with **Profile**, **Help** and **Logout**.
Header: sun/moon icon	Switches between light and dark mode.
Header: share icon	Exports the open chat as a PDF (only shown inside a chat).
Header: pin icon	Pins or unpins the open chat.
Header: speech-bubble icon	Starts a new chat (same as New Chat).

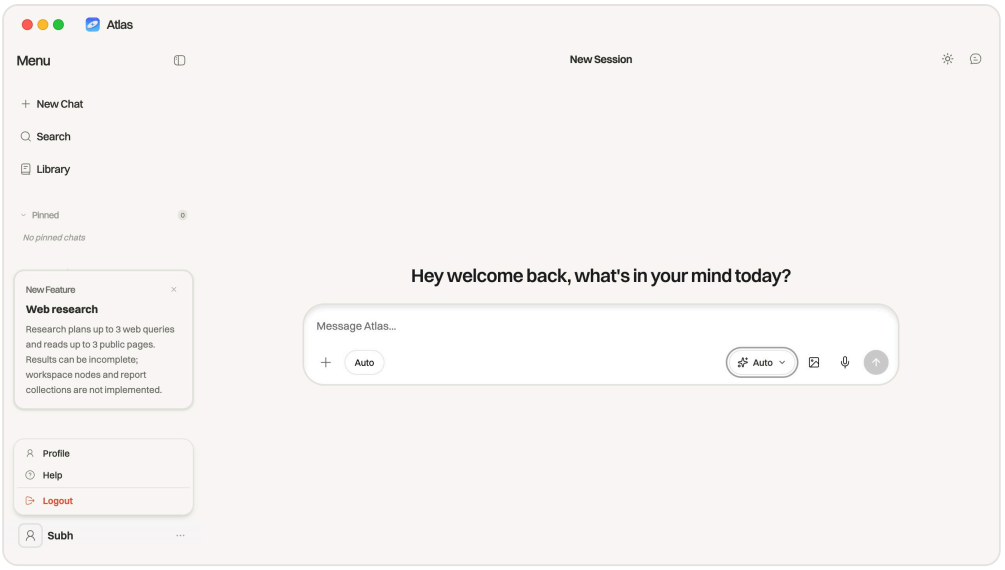


Figure 2.3 — The account menu. Click ··· next to your name to reach Profile, Help and Logout.

3 Writing a message: the composer

The composer is the rounded box at the bottom of every chat. Type your message in it and press `Enter` to send (use `Shift` + `Enter` for a new line).

CONTROL	WHERE	WHAT IT DOES
Message box	Top row	Type your question or instruction. The placeholder reads "Message Atlas…".
+ (Attach files)	Bottom left	Attach text/code files or images to your message (Chapter 8).
Mode chip (e.g. "Auto")	Next to +	Chooses what kind of help you want: Auto, Coding, Documentation, Web search, Research, Plan, Draft document, Safe tools or Generate image (Chapter 4).
Model picker (✦ Auto ▾)	Bottom right	Chooses which AI model answers, and how hard it thinks (Chapter 5).
Image icon	Bottom right	Switches the composer into image-generation mode (needs OpenAI or Gemini).
Microphone	Bottom right	Voice typing: speak and your words are transcribed into the box (needs a Groq key).
↑ **Send**	Far right	Sends the message. While a reply is streaming it becomes a **Stop** button.

What you see in a reply

- **Activity header** — e.g. "Web search · 5 sources" or "Research · 3 queries · 3 pages read". Click the arrow to expand it.
- **The answer** — formatted Markdown with clickable citation markers like `[S1]`.
- **Source chips** — the websites used, and a "Used N sources" panel with titles and snippets.
- **Memory used** — appears when Atlas recalled past conversations to answer.
- **Footer** — the time the reply took (e.g. 191.4s), a **Retry** button and a **Copy** button.

> **Errors are shown, not hidden**
> If a run fails (for example "The agent run timed out"), Atlas prints the error inside the reply. Click **Retry** or simply send the message again.

4 Modes: what kind of help you want

Click the mode chip (it says **Auto** by default) to open the mode menu. The mode tells Atlas how to approach your message. It applies to the next message you send.

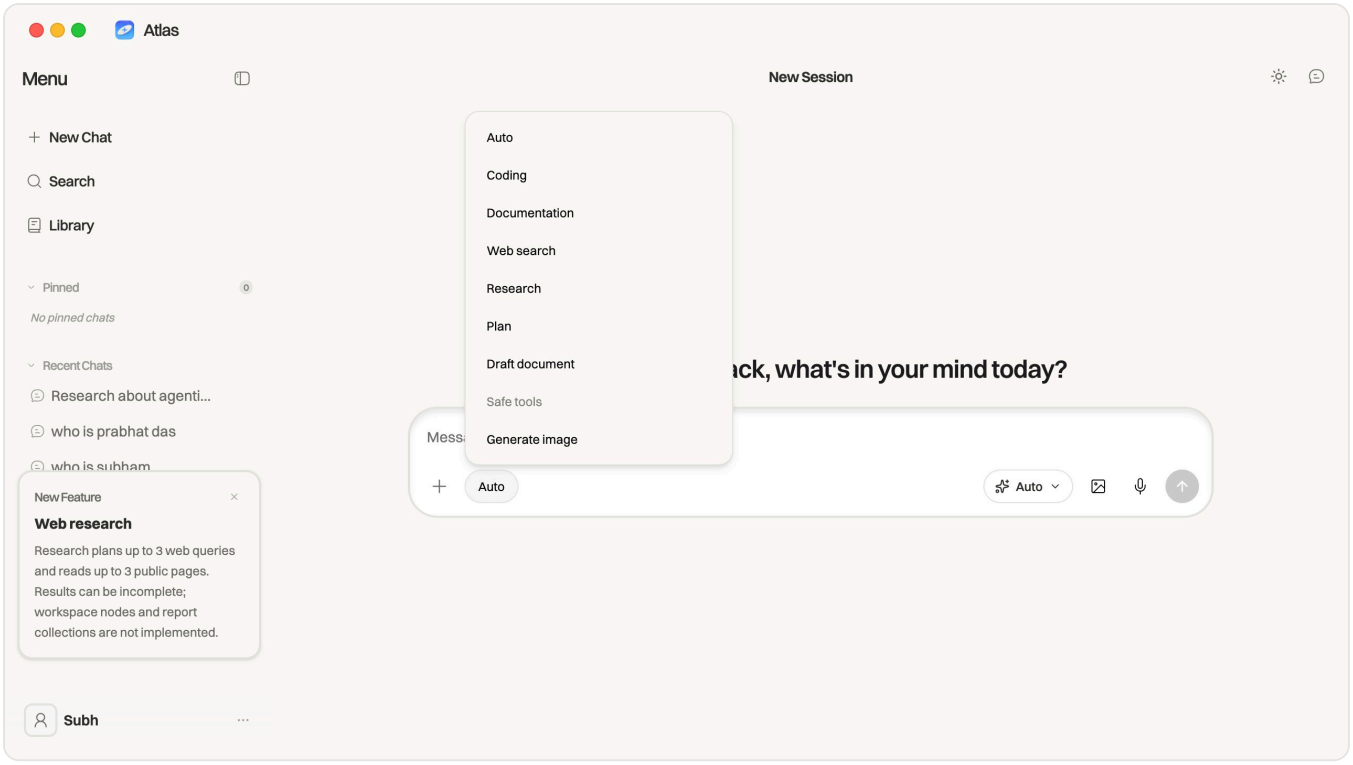


Figure 4.1 — The mode menu. Greyed-out options (here, Safe tools) are not available for the currently selected model.

MODE	USE IT WHEN…	WHAT HAPPENS
Auto	You just want an answer.	Atlas classifies the message and picks a model. If the question needs current information (for example "latest news"), it may run a quick web lookup automatically.
Coding	You are writing or debugging code.	Frames the request as a coding task for better code answers. It does not run code or edit files.
Documentation	You want explanations, docs or summaries.	Frames the request as a writing/explaining task.
Web search	You need a fast, sourced answer about something current.	Runs one web search, shows up to 5 sources and cites them in the answer.
Research	You need a more thorough, multi-source answer.	Plans up to 3 searches, keeps up to 12 unique results, reads up to 3 public pages and writes a cited answer within about 90 seconds. Results can be incomplete; partial runs are labelled.
Plan	You want to see the approach before the answer.	Produces a visible outline of steps. It does not execute anything.

Draft document	You want a ready-to-save document.	Adds a Template selector (Research brief, Comparison, Decision memo, README). See Chapter 7.
Safe tools	You want the model to decide when to search or look things up itself.	Supported OpenAI, Anthropic and Gemini models may call bounded, read-only tools. Disabled when the selected model cannot use tools; use Web search or Research instead.
Generate image	You want a picture.	Your message becomes an image prompt. Requires an OpenAI or Gemini key.

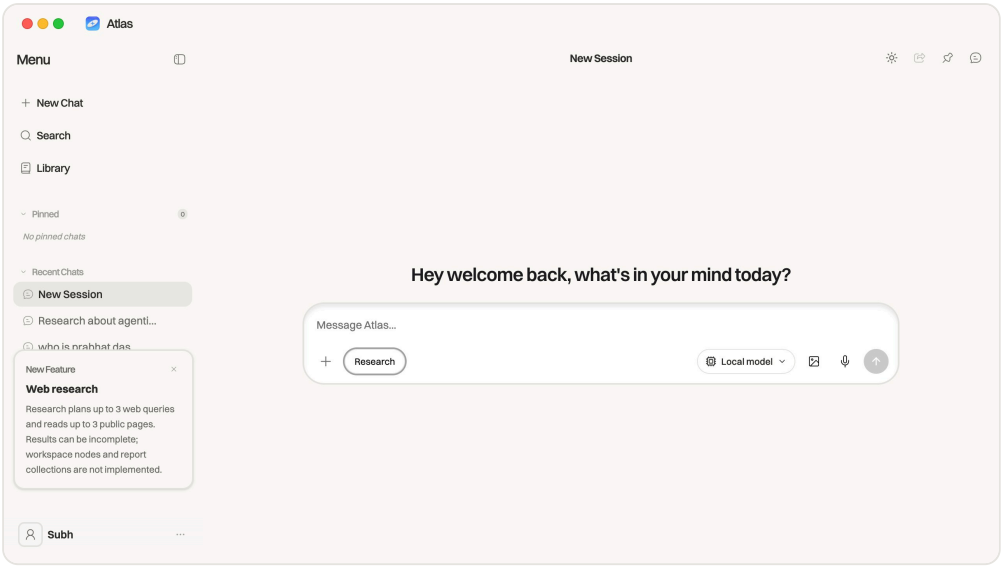


Figure 4.2 — Research mode selected. The chip shows the active mode; your next message will run as a Research task.

> **Tip**
> "Research" in the mode menu is the full multi-search workflow. Atlas's Auto classifier may also label a message as research-type, but that alone does not trigger the multi-search run — choose **Research** explicitly when you want it.

5 Choosing a model

Click the model picker (✦ Auto ▾) at the bottom right of the composer. The model you choose is used for the next message; you can switch at any time.

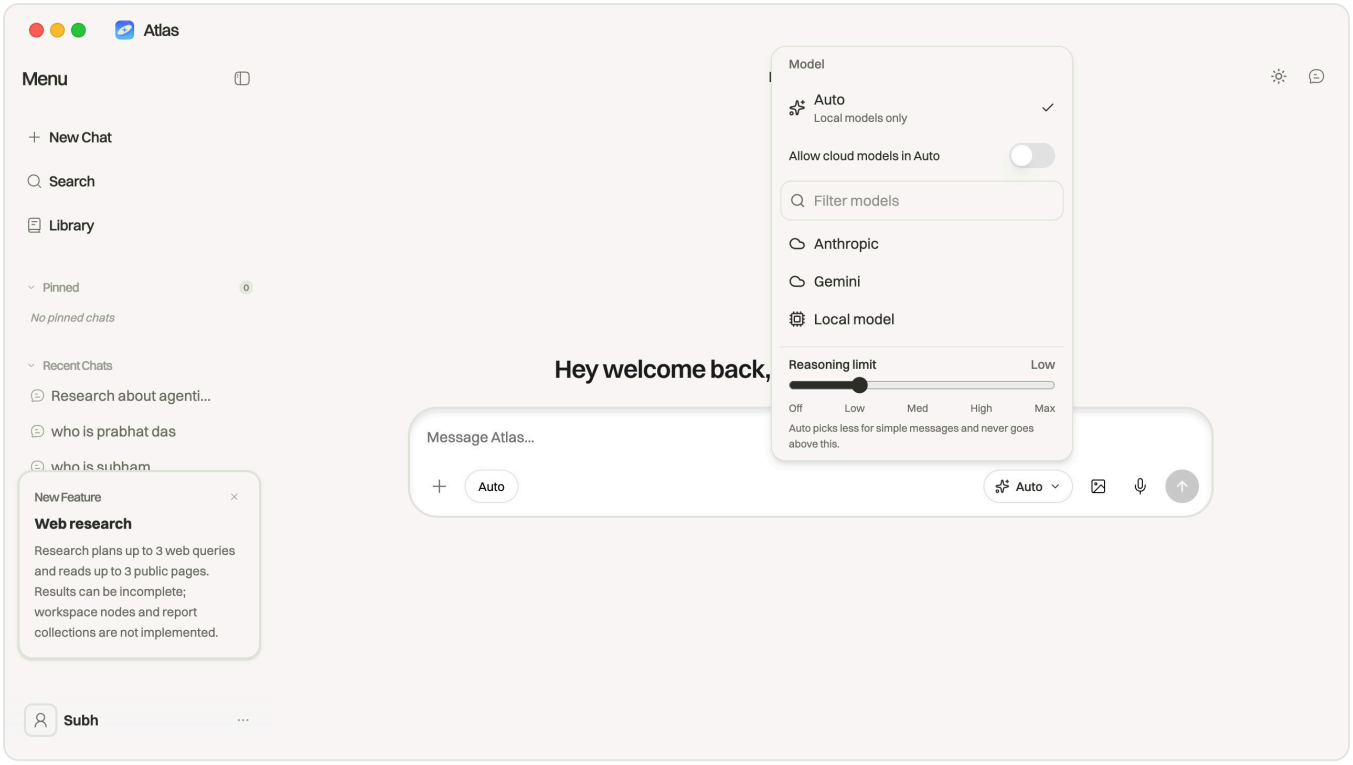


Figure 5.1 — The model picker. Auto, the cloud toggle, a model filter, your connected providers, and the reasoning slider.

Auto (recommended)

With **Auto** selected Atlas picks the model for each message. By default Auto uses **local models only** — nothing goes to a cloud provider. Turn on **Allow cloud models in Auto** to let Auto use your connected cloud providers as well; it still prefers a local model whenever one is suitable. The subtitle under Auto changes to "Local first, then connected cloud models" when the toggle is on.

Picking a specific model

Below the toggle you see every provider you have connected. In the example above that is **Anthropic**, **Gemini** and a **Local model**. A cloud icon marks cloud providers; a chip icon marks local models. Type in **Filter models** to narrow a long list. Choosing a specific model always uses that model — Atlas will not silently swap it for another if it fails; instead you will see an error telling you to check its key.

If the list says "*No providers connected — add one in Profile > Advanced*", you have not added any key or local server yet (see Chapters 12 and 13).

Reasoning

The slider at the bottom controls how much the model "thinks" before answering, on supported models:

LEVEL	BEST FOR
Off	Fastest replies; simple chat and quick facts.

Low	Default. Good balance for everyday questions.
Med	Multi-step questions, light analysis, code review.
High	Hard problems: debugging, maths, planning.
Max	The deepest thinking. Slowest and uses the most tokens.

When Auto is selected the slider is labelled **Reasoning limit**: it is a ceiling. Auto uses less for simple messages and never goes above the level you set.

> **Switching mid-conversation**
> You can change the model halfway through a chat. The new model receives a short recap of the conversation so it can continue where the previous one left off.

6 Web search and Research answers

When Atlas uses the web, the reply shows exactly what it did and where each claim came from.

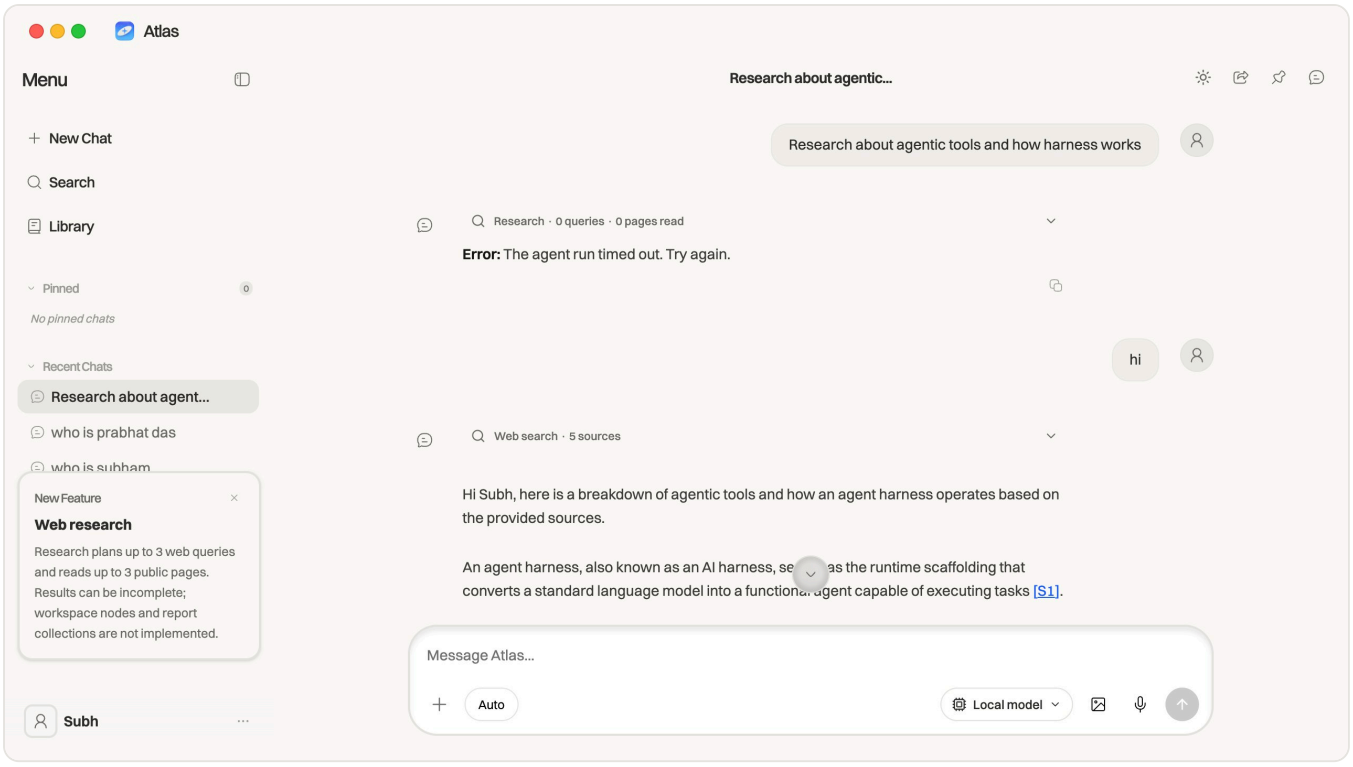


Figure 6.1 — A chat using web tools. The first attempt (Research) timed out and shows the error; the next reply used Web search with 5 sources.

Each web-backed reply begins with an **activity header** such as "Web search · 5 sources" or "Research · 2 queries · 3 pages read". Inside the answer, markers like `[S1]`, `[S2]` link each statement to a source.

Research limits

LIMIT	VALUE
Searches per Research run	Up to 3
Unique results kept	Up to 12
Public pages read in full	Up to 3
Time limit	About 90 seconds
Sources shown for Web search	Up to 5

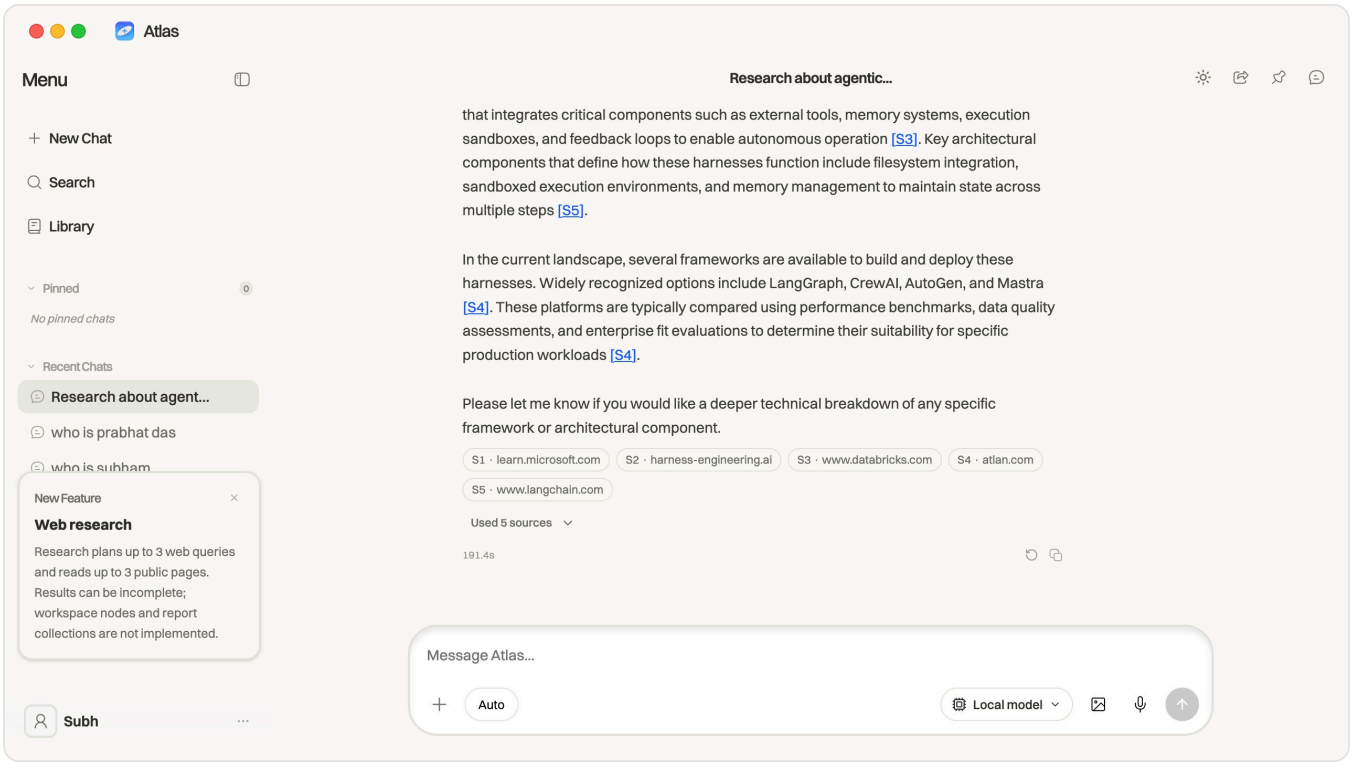


Figure 6.2 — The end of a cited answer. Source chips list the websites (S1–S5). Below them are "Used 5 sources", the response time, Retry and Copy.

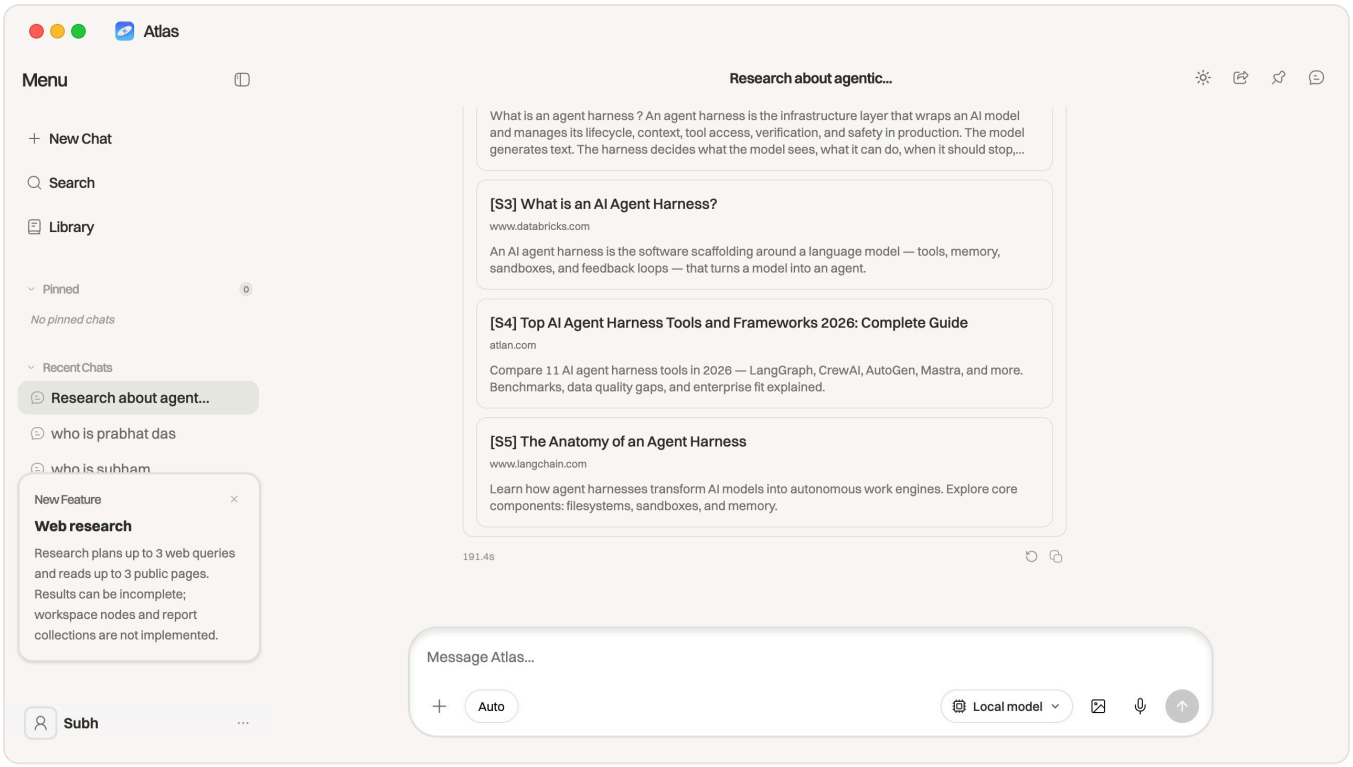


Figure 6.3 — "Used 5 sources" expanded. Each source shows its title, website and the snippet the model was given.

Always check important facts

A citation shows which source the model was given; it does not prove the source supports the sentence. Web snippets are untrusted content. If some evidence could not be retrieved, Research marks the run as **partial**.

7 Drafting documents

Draft document mode turns a request into a complete Markdown document that you review before anything is written to disk.

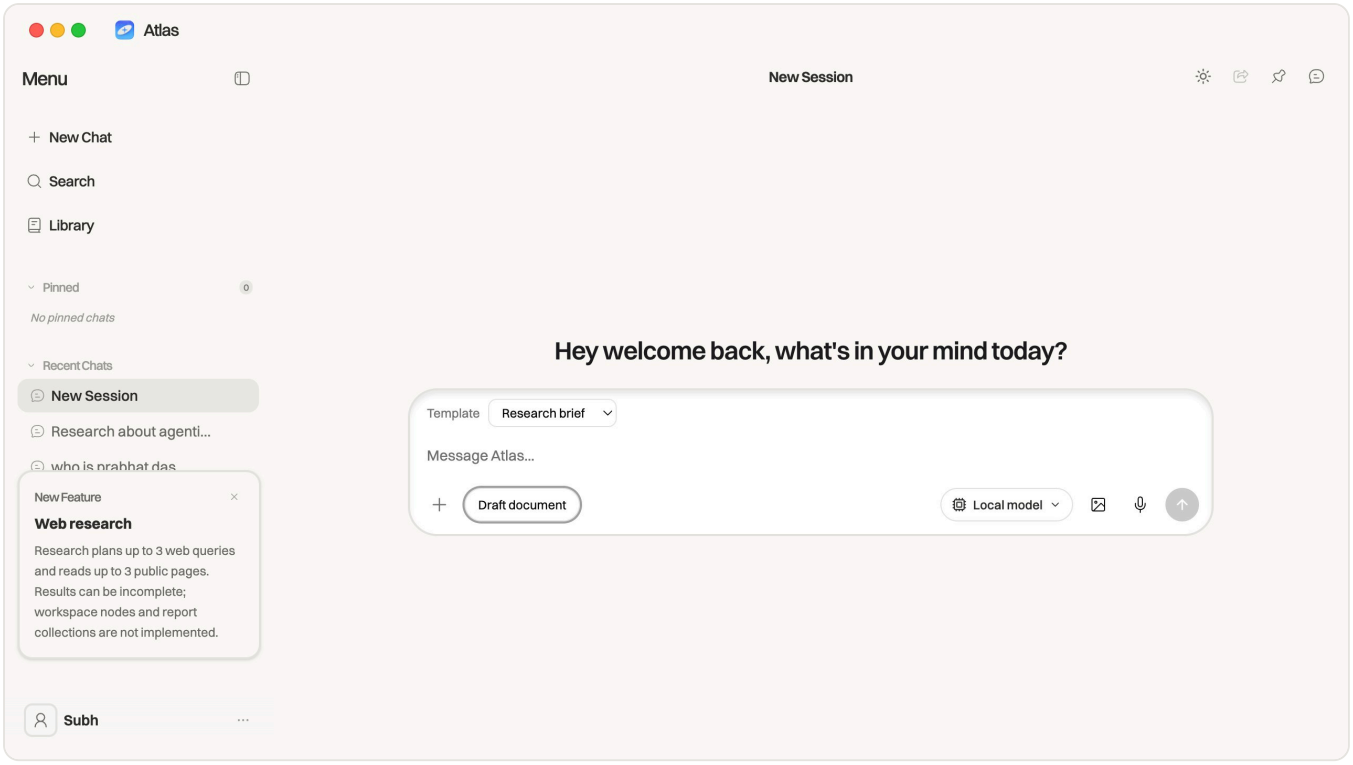


Figure 7.1 — Draft document mode. A Template selector appears above the message box.

1. Click the mode chip and choose **Draft document**.
2. Pick a **Template**: *Research brief*, *Comparison*, *Decision memo* or *README*.
3. Describe what the document should cover and send.
4. Atlas shows a **Review and save** panel with the full draft and a suggested filename.
5. Click **Choose destination** to pick where to save the .md file. Nothing is written until you choose a destination and confirm.
6. If a file already exists there, Atlas asks you to confirm replacing it. When saved you see "Saved to <path>".

TEMPLATE	GOOD FOR
Research brief	Summarising a topic with key findings and sources.
Comparison	Weighing two or more options side by side.
Decision memo	Recording a decision, the options considered and the reasoning.
README	Documentation for a project or folder.

8 Attachments, images and voice

Attaching files

Click `+` in the composer to attach files. Text-based files (.md, .txt, .csv, .json and common source-code files) are read and their content is included with your message so the model can use it. You can also attach images; models that support vision will look at them.

ATTACHMENT LIMIT	VALUE
Files per message	Up to 5 text files
Size per file	Up to 5 MiB
Total per message	Up to 10 MiB

Remove an attachment before sending by clicking the × on its chip.

Generating images

Either choose **Generate image** in the mode menu or click the **image icon** in the composer. The placeholder changes to "Describe the image to generate…". Describe the picture and send. Image generation uses OpenAI (`gpt-image-1`) or Gemini (`imagen-4.0-generate-001`), so you need one of those keys; with only Anthropic or local models connected, the option is disabled.

Voice typing

Click the **microphone**, speak, and click it again to stop. Your speech is transcribed by Groq's Whisper model (`whisper-large-v3-turbo`) and placed in the message box for you to edit and send. The first time, macOS asks for microphone permission — click Allow. Voice typing needs a Groq API key (Chapter 14).

9 Managing your chats

Chat actions

Hover a chat in the sidebar and click the ⋮ button to open its actions.

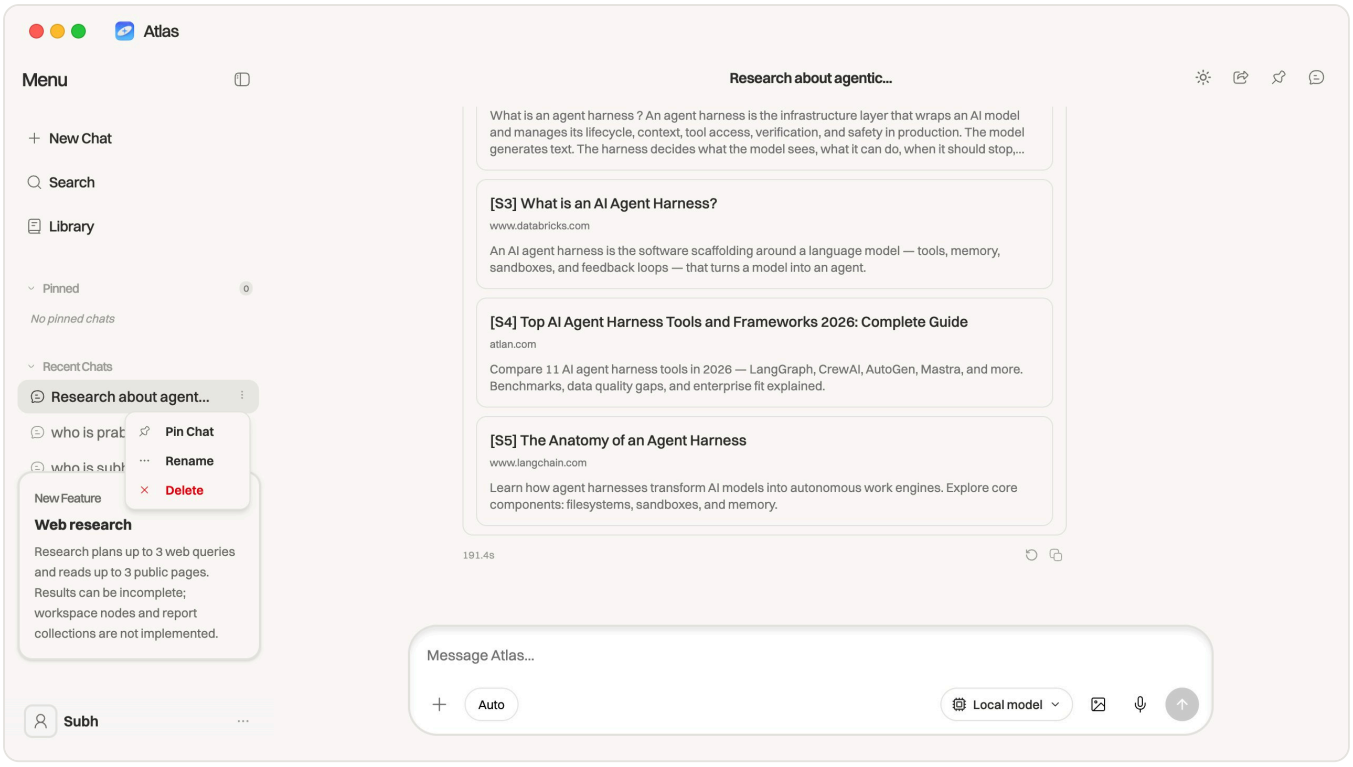


Figure 9.1 — Chat actions. Pin Chat (Unpin if already pinned), Rename and Delete.

ACTION	WHAT IT DOES
Pin Chat / Unpin	Moves the chat to (or out of) the Pinned section at the top of the sidebar.
Rename	Edit the title. New chats are titled from your first message.
Delete	Removes the chat permanently.
Export as PDF	Share icon in the chat header. Saves the whole conversation as a PDF file.

Finding a chat

Click **Search** in the sidebar and type; the chat list filters as you type. Click × to close the search. For a full-page view of every chat, open the Library.

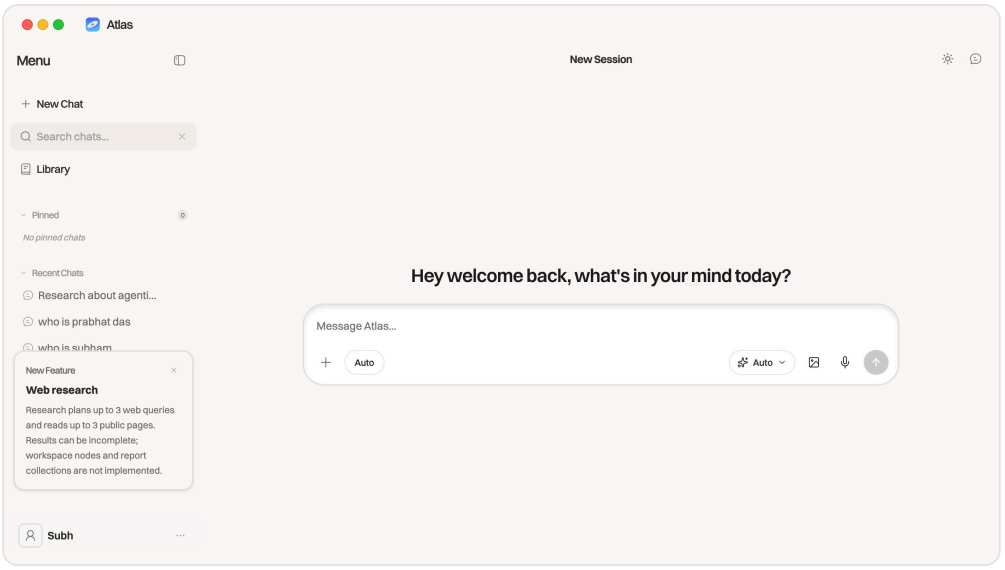


Figure 9.2 — Sidebar search.

10 The Library

Click **Library** in the sidebar to see every conversation and to manage documents you want Atlas to index.

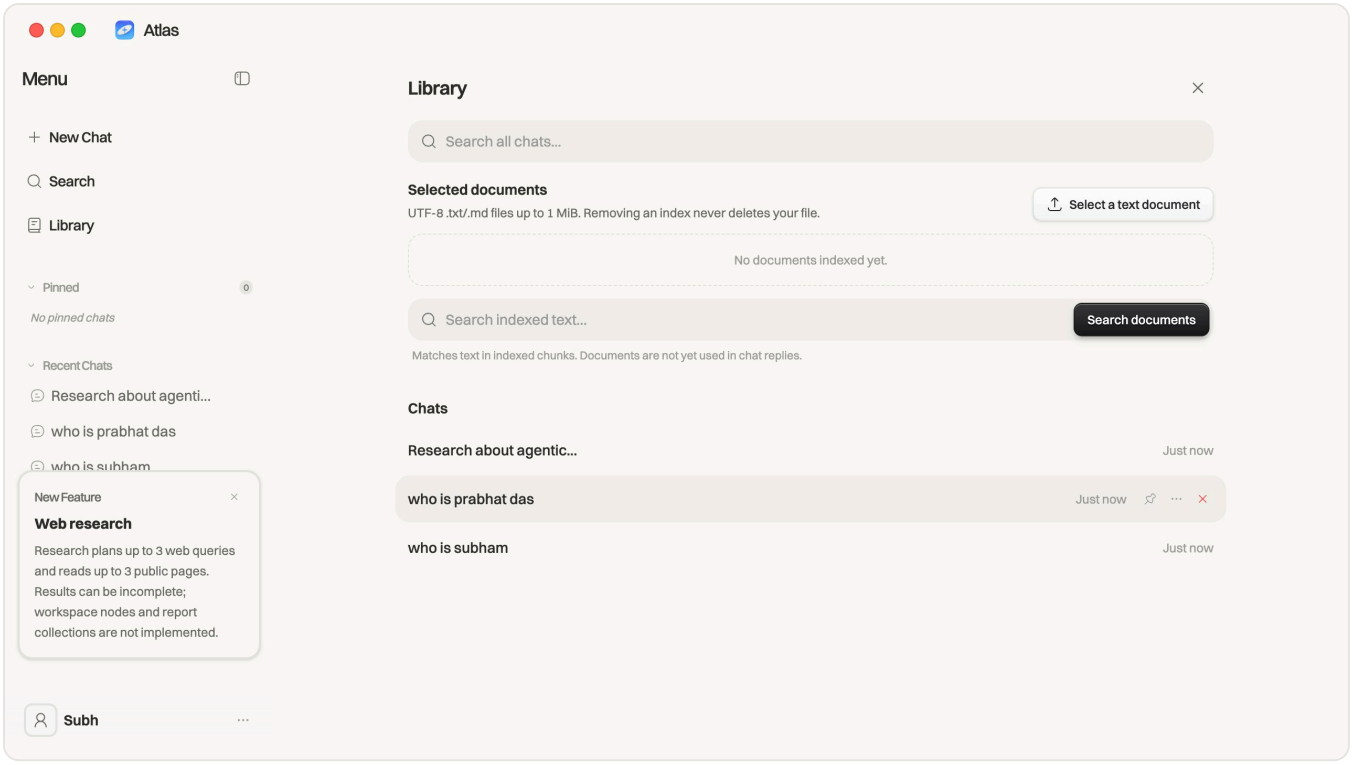


Figure 10.1 — The Library. Search all chats at the top, Selected documents in the middle, and your chat list below.

Chats

Use **Search all chats…** to search by title. Hover a chat to pin it, open more actions (⋯), or delete it (×). Click a chat to open it.

Selected documents

1. Click **Select a text document** and choose a UTF-8 **.txt** or **.md** file up to 1 MiB.
2. Atlas splits it into chunks and indexes them locally. The document then appears in the list.
3. Type in **Search indexed text…** and click **Search documents** to find matching passages, with their source and chunk.
4. To remove a document, click its remove button. Removing an index never deletes your original file.

> **Current limitation**
>
> Indexed documents are searchable here but are not yet used automatically in chat replies. To have the model read a file, attach it to your message instead.

11 Profile and personalization

Open ··· → **Profile** at the bottom of the sidebar. Close it with the × at the top right.

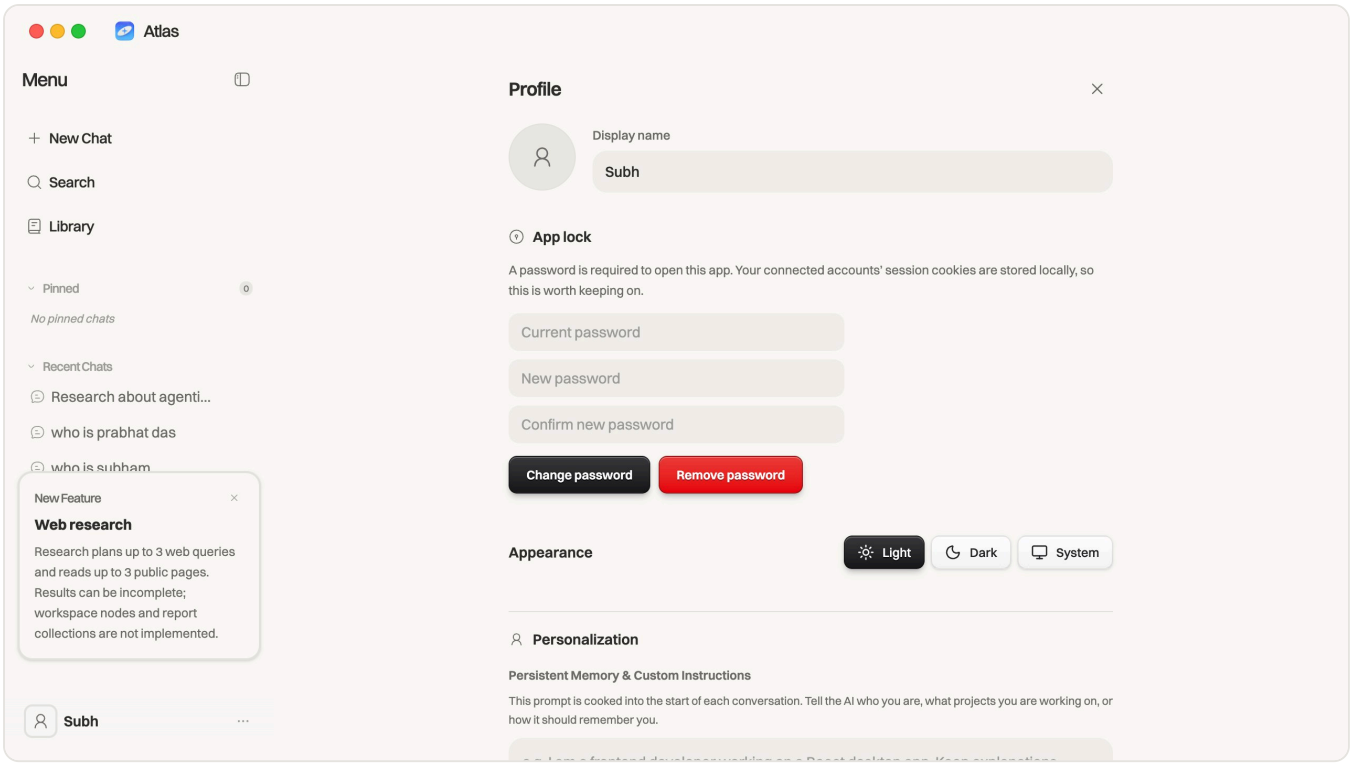


Figure 11.1 — Profile: display name, App lock and Appearance.

SETTING	HOW TO USE IT
Photo	Click the avatar circle to choose a profile picture.
Display name	The name Atlas uses to greet you and in replies. Saved automatically ("Saved" appears).
App lock	To change the password, enter the current password, the new one twice, and click **Change password**. **Remove password** turns the lock off. Keeping a password is recommended because your API keys are stored on this Mac.
Appearance	**Light**, **Dark** or **System** (follows macOS). The sun/moon icon in the chat header toggles quickly.

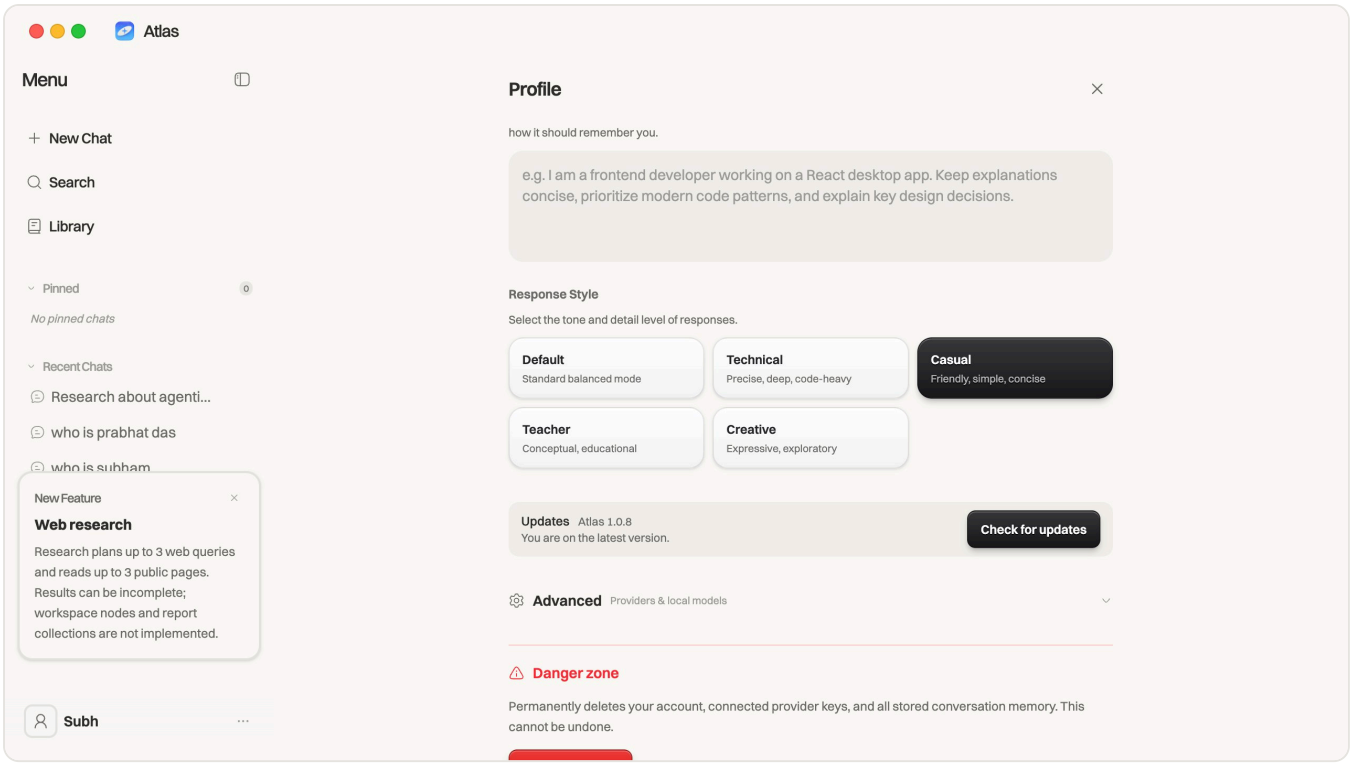


Figure 11.2 — Personalization, Response Style and Updates.

Persistent Memory & Custom Instructions

Text you write here is added to the start of every conversation. Tell Atlas who you are, what you work on, and how you like answers. Example: "*I am a frontend developer working on a React desktop app. Keep explanations concise, prioritise modern code patterns, and explain key design decisions.*"

Response Style

STYLE	TONE
Default	Standard, balanced answers.
Technical	Precise, deep, code-heavy.
Casual	Friendly, simple, concise.
Teacher	Conceptual and educational; explains the "why".
Creative	Expressive and exploratory.

Updates

The Updates card shows your version (e.g. Atlas 1.0.8). Atlas checks GitHub releases; click `Check for updates` to check now. If a newer version exists, a **Download** (or **View release**) button appears; download the new build and install it over the old one — your chats and settings are kept.

Danger zone

Delete account permanently deletes your local account, all connected provider keys and all stored conversation memory. This cannot be undone.

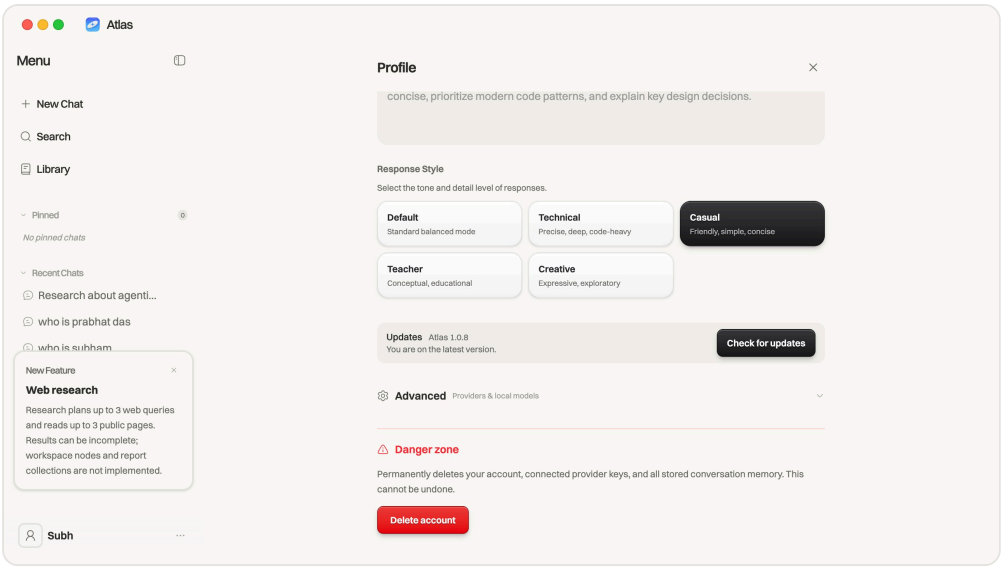


Figure 11.3 — Bottom of Profile. The collapsed **Advanced** section (click to expand) and the Danger zone.

12 Advanced: connecting API keys

Scroll to the bottom of Profile and click **Advanced — Providers & local models** to expand it. This is where you connect AI providers, local models, web search and voice typing.

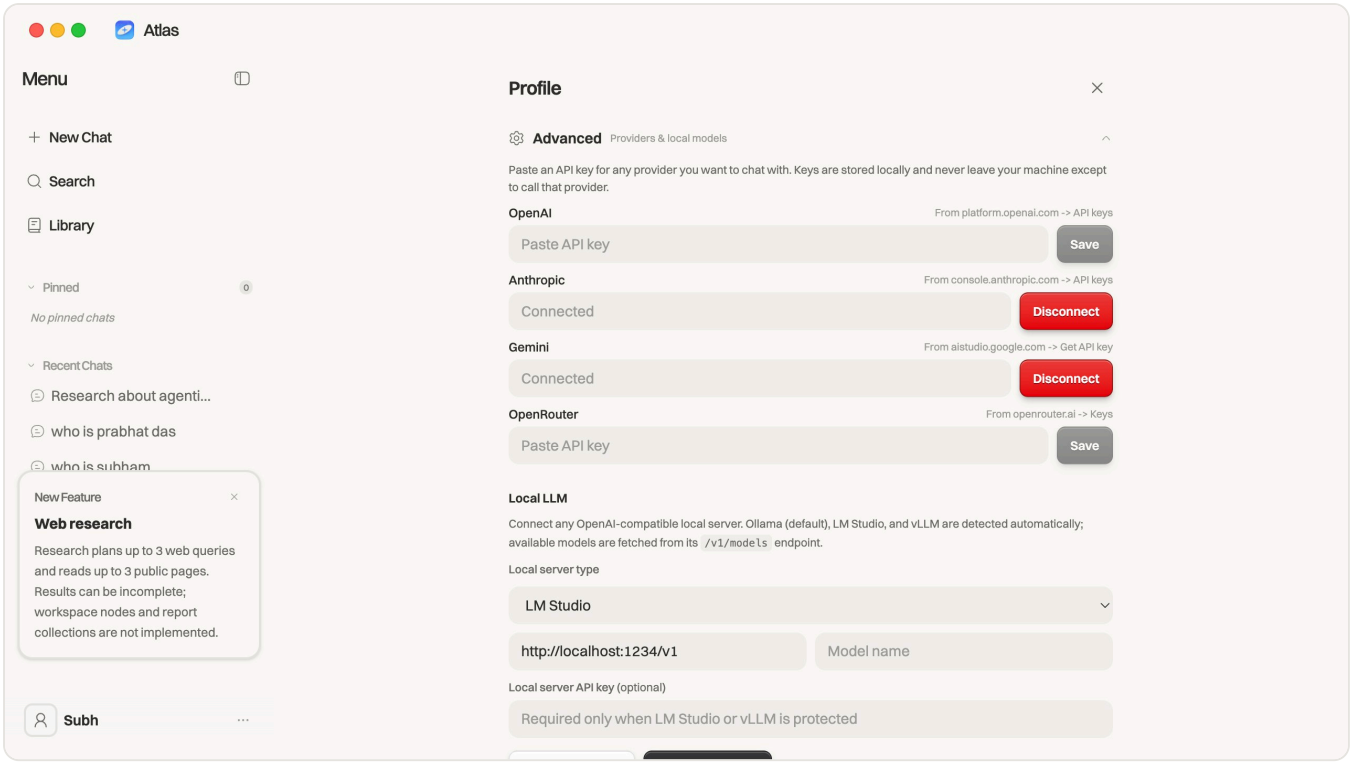


Figure 12.1 — Advanced: provider keys. Anthropic and Gemini are connected (red Disconnect buttons); OpenAI and OpenRouter are waiting for a key (Save). The hint at the right of each row says where to get the key.

How to add a key

1. Get a key from the provider's website (see the table below).
2. Paste it into that provider's **Paste API key** box.
3. Click **Save**. The button briefly shows "Saved" and the box changes to **Connected** with a **Disconnect** button. (Saving stores the key; a wrong or expired key shows up as an error the first time you chat with that provider.)
4. The provider now appears in the model picker (Chapter 5).

Keys are stored locally on your Mac and are sent only to the provider they belong to. Atlas never shows a saved key again — a connected provider just says "Connected". To replace a key, click **Disconnect** and save the new one.

Where to get each key

PROVIDER	WHERE	STEPS	COST
OpenAI	platform.openai.com	Sign in → **Dashboard / Settings** → **API keys** → **Create new secret key** → copy it (it is shown once). Keys start with `sk-`.	Pay-as-you-go; add billing credit first.

Anthropic	console.anthropic.com	Sign in → **Settings** → **API Keys** → **Create Key** → name it → copy. Keys start with `sk-ant-`.	Pay-as-you-go; add credits under Billing.
Gemini	aistudio.google.com	Sign in with a Google account → **Get API key** → **Create API key** → copy.	Has a free tier with rate limits.
OpenRouter	openrouter.ai	Sign in → **Keys** → **Create Key** → copy (starts with `sk-or-`). One key gives access to many model makers.	Prepaid credits; some free models.
Tavily (search)	app.tavily.com	Sign up → the dashboard shows your API key → copy. Optional: Atlas has free web search without a key.	Free monthly credits.
Groq (voice)	console.groq.com	Sign in → **API Keys** → **Create API Key** → copy.	Free tier available.

OpenRouter model name

After saving an OpenRouter key a small field appears for the model ID, for example `deepseek/deepseek-chat`. If you leave it empty Atlas uses `openai/gpt-4o`. Find model IDs on openrouter.ai/models.

Default cloud models

PROVIDER	DEFAULT MODEL	IMAGES	SAFE TOOLS
OpenAI	gpt-4o	Yes (gpt-image-1)	Supported models
Anthropic	claude-sonnet-4-5	No	Supported models
Gemini	gemini-2.5-flash	Yes (Imagen 4)	Supported models
OpenRouter	openai/gpt-4o (configurable)	No	No
Local	Whatever you choose	No	No

> **Keep keys private**
> An API key is like a password that spends your money. Never paste it into a chat message, a screenshot or a shared file. If a key leaks, delete it on the provider's website and create a new one.

13 Advanced: running local models

A local model runs entirely on your Mac: it is free to use, works offline, and your conversations never leave your computer. Atlas talks to any server that speaks the OpenAI-compatible API.

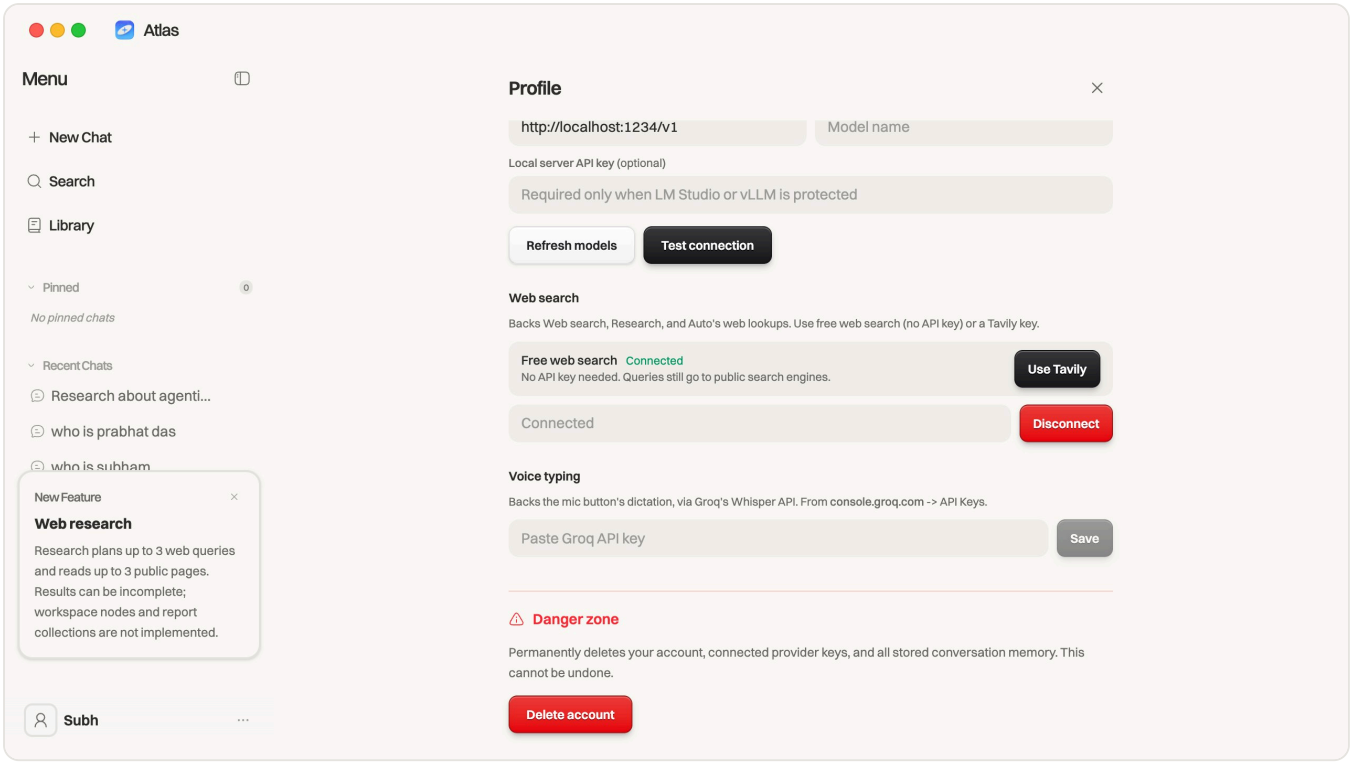


Figure 13.1 — The Local LLM, Web search and Voice typing settings. Here LM Studio is selected with its default endpoint `http://localhost:1234/v1`.

The Local LLM fields

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Local server type	Ollama (default), LM Studio, vLLM, or Custom OpenAI-compatible server. Picking a type fills in its default endpoint.
Endpoint	The server's base URL ending in `/v1`.
Model name	The model to use. Click into the field to pick from models Atlas found on the server (read from its `/v1/models` endpoint), or type one.
Local server API key	Optional. Only needed if you protected LM Studio or vLLM with a key.
Refresh models	Saves the settings and re-reads the list of models from the server.
Test connection	Checks that Atlas can reach the server and model.

SERVER	DEFAULT ENDPOINT
Ollama	`http://localhost:11434/v1`
LM Studio	`http://localhost:1234/v1`

vLLM	`http://localhost:8000/v1`
Custom	Your server's URL ending in `/v1`

Option A — Ollama (easiest)

1. Download and install Ollama from **ollama.com/download**, then open it once. It runs in the menu bar and serves on port 11434.
2. Download a model in Terminal, for example:

   ```
   ollama pull llama3.2
   ollama pull qwen3:8b
   ```

   Smaller models (1–8B parameters) run well on most Apple-silicon Macs; larger ones need more memory.
3. In Atlas, open **Profile → Advanced**, set **Local server type** to **Ollama**. The endpoint becomes `http://localhost:11434/v1`.
4. Click **Refresh models**, choose your model in **Model name**, then click **Test connection**.
5. On Apple-silicon Macs with Ollama installed, Atlas also shows a **Start Ollama / Stop Ollama** control. Atlas only stops an Ollama it started itself, and never downloads models for you.

Option B — LM Studio (graphical)

1. Install LM Studio from **lmstudio.ai** and open it.
2. Use the **Discover** (search) tab to download a model, e.g. a Llama, Qwen or Gemma build sized for your Mac.
3. Open the **Developer** tab, load the model, and switch the server to **Running** (Start Server). It listens on port 1234 by default.
4. In Atlas choose **LM Studio**; the endpoint becomes `http://localhost:1234/v1`. Click **Refresh models**, pick the model, then **Test connection**.
5. If you turned on "Require API key" in LM Studio, paste that key into **Local server API key**.

Option C — vLLM (advanced / GPU servers)

1. On a machine with a supported GPU, install vLLM (`pip install vllm`) and start a server:

   ```
   vllm serve Qwen/Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct --port 8000
   # optional: --api-key YOUR_LOCAL_KEY
   ```
2. In Atlas choose **vLLM**; the endpoint becomes `http://localhost:8000/v1`. If you used `--api-key`, enter it in **Local server API key**.
3. Refresh models, pick the model and test the connection.

Option D — any other OpenAI-compatible server

Choose **Custom OpenAI-compatible server** and enter its base URL (ending in `/v1`) and model name. llama.cpp's `llama-server`, LocalAI, Jan and similar tools work this way.

> **Local vs. Auto**
> Auto treats a model as "local" only when its endpoint is on this computer (localhost / 127.0.0.1). A server on another machine still works when selected directly, but Auto counts it as a remote model. Local models currently cannot use Safe tools or generate images; Web search and Research still work because Atlas runs the search itself.

> **Thinking models**
> Local "thinking" models (e.g. Qwen3, DeepSeek-R1) spend time reasoning before they answer. If replies are slow, lower the reasoning slider or pick a smaller model.

14 Advanced: web search and voice typing

Web search

Web search powers the **Web search** and **Research** modes, and Auto's automatic lookups for current information. You have two choices (see Figure 13.1):

OPTION	SET UP	NOTES
Free web search	One click: Atlas installs a free search helper, runs a test search and selects it. Shows **Connected** in green when active.	No API key needed. Queries still go to public search engines.
Tavily	Paste your Tavily key and save; click **Use Tavily** to switch to it.	Often higher-quality results; uses your Tavily credits.

You can switch between them at any time. If neither is set up, web lookups are skipped and Atlas says so rather than pretending it searched.

Voice typing

1. Create a key at **console.groq.com** → **API Keys**.
2. Paste it into **Paste Groq API key** and click **Save**.
3. Use the microphone button in the composer (Chapter 8). Allow microphone access when macOS asks.

15 Memory, privacy and your data

Memory

Atlas can remember. When enabled, it stores your conversations in a local database on your Mac, recalls relevant past conversations when you ask something related, and keeps a rolling summary of long chats. When memory was used for a reply, a **Memory used (N recalls)** panel appears under it showing which past conversations or summary were used. Custom Instructions (Chapter 11) are a separate, always-on note you control.

Where your data goes

DATA	STORED	SENT TO
Chats & memory	On your Mac	Only to the model you choose. Local model → stays on your Mac. Cloud model → that provider (with relevant memory context).
API keys	On your Mac	Only to the provider each key belongs to.
Web searches	—	Public search engines (free search) or Tavily.
Voice recordings	—	Groq, for transcription.
Attachments	In the chat	The model you send them to.
Saved drafts / PDF exports	Where you choose	Nowhere.

> **Maximum privacy**
>
> Use a local model with Auto set to "Local models only" (cloud toggle off), and avoid Web search and voice typing. Then nothing you type leaves your Mac.

Dark mode

Everything in Atlas is available in dark mode. Toggle it with the sun/moon icon in the header or in **Profile → Appearance**.

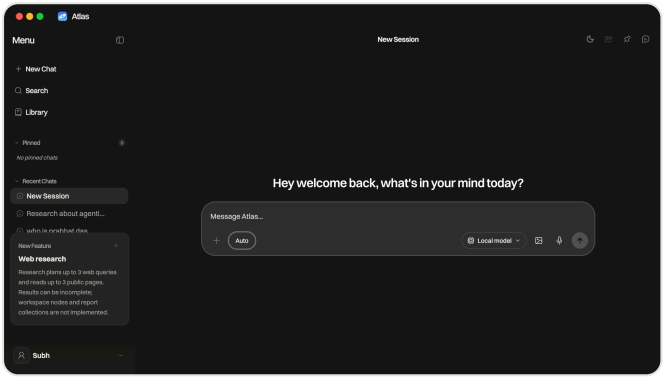


Figure 15.1 — Home in dark mode.

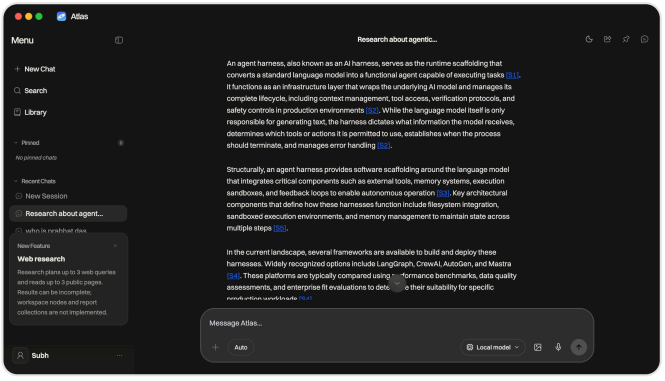


Figure 15.2 — A chat in dark mode.

16 Troubleshooting and FAQ

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
"No providers connected" in the model picker	Add a key or a local server in Profile → Advanced (Chapters 12–13).
A cloud model returns an authentication error	The key is wrong, expired or out of credit. Disconnect it, create a new key on the provider's site, and save it again. Check billing.
Auto never uses my cloud model	Turn on "Allow cloud models in Auto" in the model picker. Auto still prefers a local model when one fits — pick the cloud model directly to force it.
Local model: Test connection fails	Make sure the server is running (Ollama app open / LM Studio server Running / vLLM started) and the port matches the endpoint. Try opening the endpoint + `/models` in a browser.
Local model list is empty	Download a model first (`ollama pull …` or LM Studio Discover), then click Refresh models.
Local replies are slow or empty	Use a smaller model, lower the reasoning level, or close other heavy apps. Thinking models may take a while before the first word.
"The agent run timed out"	Research has a ~90 s budget. Retry, use Web search for a quicker answer, or pick a faster model.
Safe tools is greyed out	The selected model cannot call tools. Choose a supported OpenAI, Anthropic or Gemini model, or use Web search / Research.
Generate image is unavailable	Connect an OpenAI or Gemini key.
Mic button does nothing	Add a Groq key, and allow Atlas in System Settings → Privacy & Security → Microphone.
Web search says it could not search	Set up Free web search or a Tavily key in Advanced → Web search.
Attachment rejected	Max 5 text files, 5 MiB each, 10 MiB total.
Forgot app password	The lock is local; there is no online reset. If you are still signed in, change or remove it in Profile → App lock.

17 Quick reference

Where to find things

I WANT TO…	GO TO
Start a new chat	Sidebar → New Chat, or the speech-bubble icon in the header
Change the model	Composer → model picker (✦ Auto ▾)
Search the web / research	Composer → mode chip → Web search / Research
Write a document	Mode chip → Draft document → Template
Add an API key	··· → Profile → Advanced
Use a local model	··· → Profile → Advanced → Local LLM
Set custom instructions	··· → Profile → Personalization
Change theme	Header sun/moon, or Profile → Appearance
Export a chat	Open the chat → share icon (Export as PDF)
Pin / rename / delete	Sidebar → ⋮ on the chat, or Library
Check for updates	Profile → Updates → Check for updates

Limits and defaults

ITEM	VALUE
Web search sources	Up to 5
Research	≤ 3 searches, ≤ 12 results, ≤ 3 pages read, ~90 s
Text attachments	≤ 5 files, ≤ 5 MiB each, ≤ 10 MiB total
Indexed documents	UTF-8 .txt / .md, ≤ 1 MiB each
Reasoning levels	Off · Low (default) · Med · High · Max
Auto default	Local models only (cloud is opt-in)
Ollama / LM Studio / vLLM ports	11434 / 1234 / 8000
Image models	OpenAI gpt-image-1, Gemini Imagen 4
Voice model	Groq whisper-large-v3-turbo

What Atlas does not do (yet)

Atlas does not run shell commands or code, does not write files without your explicit confirmation, does not crawl folders, and does not ingest PDF or Office files. There are no Atlas-managed cloud accounts, subscriptions or usage quotas — you always use your own keys or your own local models.